

FORGE Phase 1 · Week 1 · Session 1 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 1: Welcome to FORGE" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 1 as written runs about 90 minutes. This insert adds two pieces of media and fills the session to two hours without changing any of its content.

What's in this insert

- **The Session 1 video, "Welcome to FORGE"** (4 min 28 s). It tells why FORGE exists, the stakeholder idea, what a FORGE mentor is, the three phases, what today holds, and the elevator speech on screen. It ends on the stakeholder question and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **A mentorship talk:** Shaka Senghor, *Why your worst deeds don't define you* (TED, 2014, about 15 minutes), with discussion questions.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening: welcome and go-around	10	As written.
0:10	Session 1 video	5	Play straight through right after the go-around.
0:15	The FORGE Story: your own "why," then the stakeholder discussion	10	The video has told the story. Take two minutes for your own reason for being here, then open the question the video ends on. Let four or five men answer. Don't argue or correct.
0:25	Program Overview: schedule, attendance, questions	15	The video covered the three phases. Spend this time on the schedule, the attendance rule, lateness, and practical questions.
0:40	Mentorship talk: Shaka Senghor	15	Introduce it in one sentence: "This man served 19 years for murder. Listen for what changed him."
0:55	Talk discussion	15	Questions below.
1:10	Elevator Speech	15	Replay 3:15 to 3:53 of the Session 1 video to read the speech together, then pair practice as written.
1:25	Code of Conduct and Participant Commitment	20	As written.
1:45	Closing go-around and homework	10	As written.
1:55	Buffer	5	Count times, movement and late starts.

Discussion questions for the Shaka Senghor talk

1. Shaka says the worst thing he did does not define him. Do you believe that about yourself? About the man sitting next to you? What makes it hard to believe?
2. What turned him around? He names mentors, books, his own writing, and a letter from his son. Which of those do you have access to right now?
3. Think of someone who played a mentor's role for you, even once. What did that person actually do? (*Write the answers where everyone can see them. That list is the job description of a FORGE mentor.*)
4. Shaka changed himself first, then worked on what was around him. How does that match the way FORGE is built, with Phase 1 before Phase 2?
5. Tonight's journal question is "What does it mean to you to be a stakeholder?" How do you think Shaka would answer it?

Preview the talk before the session. Shaka describes his crime plainly and talks about years in solitary confinement. It is widely shown in schools and contains no graphic imagery, but the room should not be surprised.

Getting a copy you can play without internet

- Talk page: https://www.ted.com/talks/shaka_senghor_why_your_worst_deeds_don_t_define_you
- YouTube (TED's official channel): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GtXyGFMBWBs>

TED talks carry a Creative Commons BY-NC-ND license. TED's usage policy says a single talk used in one lesson is generally permitted, with credit to TED. It also says a talk used as a standing part of a curriculum across many sessions or cohorts "may require a separate license," and that talks should not be scraped from TED's site. FORGE will show this talk to every cohort, so write to TED (help.ted.com, licensing) for an offline copy for a nonprofit, no-fee, in-prison program. Show it whole and unedited, with TED's title card.

Check the talk against the facility's rules for outside media before the first session.

Later this week (suggestions)

- **Session 3, "What Is Service?":** Drew Dudley, *Everyday leadership* (about 6 minutes). A small act of kindness changed someone's life without him knowing it. YouTube: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uAy6EawKKME>
- **Session 3, "Learning from Other Programs":** *Healing inside prison*, Jacques Verduin (GRIP's founder) and Fateen Jackson, TEDxSanQuentin 2016. GRIP is one of the programs FORGE is built on. YouTube: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iGlvDfiwEdA>. Ask the GRIP Training Institute directly for a copy (grip-traininginstitute.org).

Checklist additions

- ☐ Session 1 video loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Mentorship talk loaded, previewed, and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ Easel paper or board ready for question 3's list